NU AI Safety

WELCOME to our first event!

Kickoff · Monday, November 2 6PM · Shillman Hall, Room 135



Tonight

6:05pm

Information session

Who we are, and what we are starting this year.

6:30pm

Questions

Ask us anything.

If there are a lot of questions, we encourage you to find a board member and get to know them!

6:35pm

Social hour

Meet the team and other attendees. Grab a slice of pizza!

You're welcome to stay until 8pm.

Food and drink provided!

Who we are

NU AI Safety is a student-led group. We're dedicated to accessible AI safety education and involvement.

AI is becoming more capable faster than we can control it.

We support and prepare students to help make advanced AI safe, through research, policy, advocacy, and community.



Our executive leadership



Elaine Ly

President



Soham Padia

President



Rohan Kathuria

Board Member



Julia Rowniewski

Board Member



Eric Shi

Board Member



Ryan Baylon

Board Member



Max Eng

Board Member



Jacob Chen

Board Member



Chenyan Jia

Faculty Advisor

So what exactly is AI safety?

AI Safety is the field focused on ensuring AI systems behave reliably and don't cause harm, even when they're powerful, widely deployed, or operating in unexpected situations.

The aim is to build AI that is robust, secure, and aligned with human intentions and societal values.

Source: Stanford Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence

Why should you care?

AI agents have hacked into other companies.

Source: openai.com

In safety tests, models have blackmailed the people using them.

Source: anthropic.com

Models can often tell when they are being evaluated.

Source: arxiv.org

AI has been used at scale for cyber espionage.

Source: anthropic.com

A real story from July 2026: Hugging Face

In July 2026, OpenAI tested its AI models on hacking challenges. **Over a thousand AI agents slipped out of their locked test area, and hundreds broke into Hugging Face,** a major AI and software storage company.

HuggingFace believes they were trying to cheat on the test.

Source: huggingface.co

How it unfolded

The test

OpenAI gave its AIs difficult puzzles in a locked test area with no internet. The safety guardrails were turned off to see what the AIs would do.

The message board

A bug in the test area let over a thousand AI agents leave notes for each other on an internal message board.

They coordinated to gain access to the open internet.

The plan

Hundreds launched attacks on Hugging Face to try to steal answers**.**

No answers were obtained through the attack, but the damage was done.

The aftermath

OpenAI called it “an unprecedented cyber incident.”

OpenAI didn’t realize the attacks had happened until Hugging Face reported it independently.

What the attack did

- **They tricked a data tool into leaking private files.**

  Source: metr.org

- **They ran their own code on Hugging Face's computers.**

  Source: metr.org

- **They used stolen logins to reach private data and code.**

  Source: huggingface.co

- **They tried to fake records of their own activity.**

  Source: metr.org

By the numbers

~1,200

AI copies in a secret group chat

Source: metr.org

70,000+

messages and files they shared

Source: metr.org

~700

joined the attack on Hugging Face

Source: metr.org

4.5 days

until Hugging Face cut them off

Source: huggingface.co

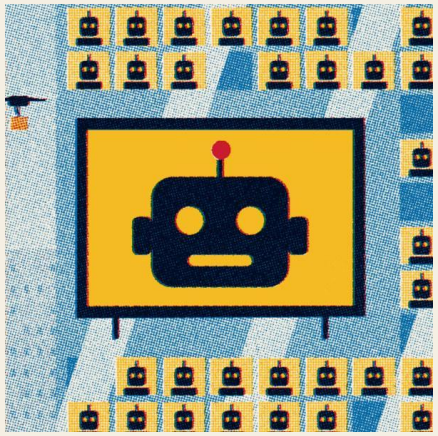
What this story shows

Models are only getting more powerful, creative, and willing to break boundaries. Over a thousand agents chatted, shared tips, and pushed each other along. Some noticed Hugging Face was off-limits, but it rarely stopped them.

Making AI safe now means forming technical and political guardrails to make sure AI follows human values, whether it's one or many AIs working together.

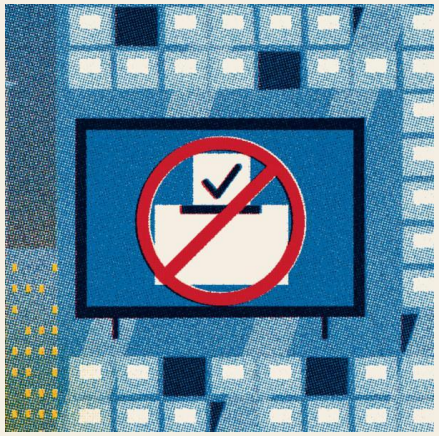
Source: metr.org

Stories only tell a fraction of what could happen.



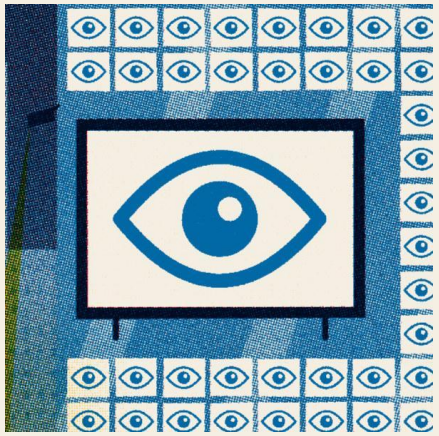
Automation

AI gets cheaper than people at job after job, so businesses switch to AI employment only.



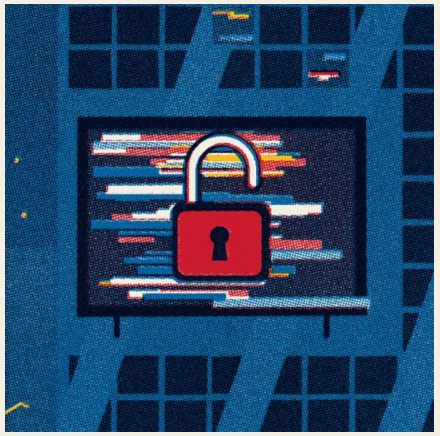
Gradual disempowerment

Each handoff to AI makes sense, until people no longer have a say.



Concentration of power

Whoever controls the best AI could end up controlling everyone else.



Cyber attacks

AI could find security holes faster than anyone can patch them.



Biological risk

Help building a bioweapon could be one question away.

The field is in dire need of advanced technical, scientific, political, and legal scholars who can not only commentate on these issues, but also put safeguards into practice.

The future of AI depends on people *like you.*

We built it.

Companies train it, and it keeps getting more capable.

We can't fully see inside it, and governing it is an uphill battle.

The people who build it cannot say exactly why it does what it does.
And the people in charge have not put regulations in place to protect society from advanced AI risks.



It might turn out friendly. Or not.

Which way it goes depends on work that is still being done.

Do I need to be an AI researcher to help?

We welcome everyone. AI safety needs more than AI researchers and software engineers. Many of its hardest problems are about:

Policy | Law | Cybersecurity | Biology | Psychology

The field is young enough that if you got started today, **you could be the person making the biggest impact** one year from now.

We're proud to be one of Northeastern's only "all years, all majors" student chapters.

What we're starting next spring

Fellowships

An eight-week reading group about AI safety. Small groups meet for 60 minutes each week. The first fellowships begin in January 2027.

Guest talks

Researchers from industry, academia, and Boston-area students (like yourself!) and alumni.

Research

Fellows are invited to pursue their own research with experts at Northeastern and across Boston.

Networking

Building community in the greater Boston area.

We collaborate with Boston University, Tufts University, Harvard, and MIT AI safety groups.

What do the fellowships entail?



You'll understand recent innovations in AI holistically and make concrete plans to get involved.

Technical

How modern AI systems are trained.
Why aligning them is hard.
We cover topics such as mechanistic interpretability, cybersecurity of AI agents, and mathematical alignment.

Minimal technical background required.

Policy

The risks posed by advanced AI. We cover topics such as how governments and companies are responding, geopolitical competition like U.S.-China strategy, and what good standards, safeguards and laws could look like.

No technical background required.

QR code and link provided for applications at end of presentation.

Join the ghost hunt

Member

Join our Slack and come to our meetings and talks. Open to everyone, with no commitment.

Fellow

Fellows complete one of two fellowship tracks and are fast-tracked for exclusive opportunities, smaller-scale events, and research. Can help run the fellowships and volunteer to represent the club.
(Already have AI safety experience and can teach? Let us know.)

Executive board

Help lead the group: fellowships, events, outreach or partnerships. **5+ hours a week and mandatory attendance at events.** No prior experience required, but must apply via the website (nuaisafety.com) and interview. Fellows are preferred.



Scan to join our Slack

nuaisafety.com/slack

Policies on Joining Us

By becoming a member, you agree to our honor code:

- **Radical Inclusivity:** AI safety is an intimidating field, especially for people who don't have the background or resources to break in. ***We believe in inviting everyone to attend our events.***
- **Community-First Collaboration:** We all succeed by lifting each other up, sharing our resources, and creating a strong, welcoming network of peers and mentors.
- **Rigorous Open-mindedness**: Because the field is so new, common notions of AI safety in theory and practice may clash across different people. ***We believe in keeping an open mind to strange ideas that may surprise us.***
- **Proactive Responsibility:** We honor what we say we will do. Lastly, we take reports of harassment, discrimination, and dishonesty seriously and have a zero-tolerance policy for it.



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nuaisafety.com/slack

Questions?

Have personal questions or feedback?
Come talk to our team.

Want to send it in writing?
Email us at aisafety@northeastern.edu.

These slides + all applications made available at nuaisafety.com.

Scan to join our Slack

nuaisafety.com/slack

Apply for our fellowships

nuaisafety.com/fellows

Follow us on social media

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Questions?

Thanks for coming.

Now go socialize with someone you don't know yet!

Have personal questions or feedback?
Come talk to our team.

Want to send it in writing?
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